

[US-Iran talks](#) [Madison Square Garden death](#) [Taylor Swift](#) [World Cup 2026](#)

WORLD NEWS

At least 32 killed in southeastern Congo after bridge at mine collapsed, authorities say

BY [JANVIER BARHAHIGA](#) AND [MARK BANCHEREAU](#)

Updated 10:53 PM GMT+2, November 16, 2025

[Leer en español](#)

BUKAVU, Congo (AP) — A bridge at a copper and cobalt mine in southeastern Congo collapsed due to overcrowding, killing at least 32 people, a regional government official said Sunday.

The bridge at the Kalandu mine in Mulondo in Lualaba province fell on Saturday, Roy Kaumba Mayonde, the province's interior minister, said during a press conference.

"Despite the strict prohibition on accessing the site due to heavy rainfall and the risk of landslides, illegal diggers forced their way into the quarry," Mayonde said.

A report by the Congo's Artisanal and Small-Scale Mining Support and Guidance Service, or SAEMAPE, government agency on Sunday said the gunfire from soldiers at the site sparked panic among the miners who rushed to the bridge resulting in the fall that left them "piled on top of each other causing the deaths and injuries." While Mayonde put the death toll at at least 32, the report said at least 40 people had lost their lives.

ADVERTISEMENT



The presence of soldiers at the mine had long been at the center of a dispute between wildcat miners, a cooperative meant to organize operations, and the site's legal operators, the report added.

RELATED STORIES



Rescuers dig for bodies after a mining explosives blast in Myanmar kills at least 43

3 MIN READ



In Sudan's war economy, gold keeps flowing as miners risk mercury and collapse

3 MIN READ



Authorities investigate safety lapses after China coal mine blast kills at least 82

3 MIN READ

Congo is the [world's largest producer of cobalt](#), a mineral used to make lithium-ion batteries for electric vehicles and other products, with Chinese companies controlling 80% of the production in the central African country.

Accusations of child labor, unsafe conditions, and corruption have long [plagued the country's cobalt mining industry](#).

Mineral-rich eastern Congo has for decades been ripped apart by violence from government forces and different armed groups, including the Rwanda-backed M23, whose recent resurgence has escalated the conflict, worsening an [already acute humanitarian crisis](#).

—

Banchereau reported from Dakar, Senegal.



MARK BANCHEREAU

Banchereau covers 22 countries across West and Central Africa for The Associated Press. He is based in Dakar, Senegal.



ADVERTISEMENT



MOST READ

1 **US-Iran negotiations end, technical talks will continue after Trump shakes talks with threats**
5 MIN READ  1531

2 **Man falls to his death during rock concert at Madison Square Garden**
1 MIN READ  117

3 **Trump tries to blame Reflecting Pool woes on vandalism, without ‘any’ substantiation**
3 MIN READ  1891

4 **In Taylor Swift’s beach town, every clue becomes a wedding rumor**
5 MIN READ  32

5 **Trump deepens the dustup with Italy’s Meloni, who says his ‘unprovoked attacks are senseless’**
3 MIN READ  671

ADVERTISEMENT